Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Parathyroid Hormone, Phosphorus, Calcium and Magnesium Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Serum intact parathyroid (PTH) testing (CPT code 83970*) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with any of the following conditions at the designated frequency:

  - As needed for individuals who have:
    - The following signs of hypoparathyroidism:
      - Abnormal magnesium
      - Elevated serum phosphorus
      - Hypercalciuria
      - Hypocalcemia
      - Low calcitriol
    - Abnormal calcium
    - Familial medullary thyroid carcinoma
    - Multiple endocrine neoplasia type 2A
    - Osteoporosis or low bone mass
    - Undergone parathyroidectomy
  - One test per year for individuals who have been diagnosed with hyperparathyroidism but who have not undergone parathyroidectomy
  - One test every 12 months for individuals who have been diagnosed with stage 3 chronic kidney disease (CKD)
  - One test every three months for individuals who have been diagnosed with stage 4 or stage 5 CKD
  - One test every three months for individuals who are younger than 18 years of age and who have been diagnosed with pseudohypoparathyroidism type 1A or type 1B, pseudopseudohypoparathyroidism, progressive osseous heteroplasia or acrodysostosis
  - One test per year for individuals who are 18 years of age or older and who have been diagnosed with pseudohypoparathyroidism type 1A or type 1B, pseudopseudohypoparathyroidism, progressive osseous heteroplasia or acrodysostosis

- The following tests **ARE NOT REIMBURSABLE** for individuals with a primary diagnosis representing a general encounter without abnormal findings:
  - Serum, blood or fecal magnesium testing (CPT code 83735**)
  - Serum ionized calcium (CPT code 82330) or urine calcium testing (CPT code 82340)
  - Urine phosphorus or phosphate testing (CPT code 84105)

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
82330	Calcium; ionized
82340	Calcium; urine quantitative, timed specimen
83735**	Magnesium
83970*	Parathormone (parathyroid hormone)
84105	Phosphorus inorganic (phosphate); urine

Original Medicare Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs)

Contractor Name	Policy Title	Policy Number	Procedure Code
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	Serum Magnesium	L36700	83735
Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC	Serum Magnesium	L36702	83735
Palmetto GBA	Magnesium	L39400	83735
First Coast Service Options, Inc.	Parathormone (Parathyroid Hormone)	L34018	83970

**The payment criteria for 83970 apply to all Medicare jurisdictions, except for First Coast Service Options.*
***The payment criterion for 83735 applies to all Medicare jurisdictions, except for Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC and Palmetto GBA.*

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